

C09 NEW MOTHER SUPPORT | O (MAX : 3 PT)

Intent : Provide spaces and policies that encourage and support breastfeeding.

Summary : This WELL feature requires the provision of dedicated lactation rooms with supportive amenities, as well as paid break times, travel accommodations and resources to help mothers initiate and sustain breastfeeding.

Issue : New mothers represent a significant segment of the global labor force, and postpartum care is essential to the health of breastfeeding women and their babies.^{1,2} Research shows that a lack of workplace accommodations contributes to shorter breastfeeding duration or leads to a drop in milk supply, resulting in early weaning.² Nursing parents need a safe, private space with essential amenities to continue breastfeeding or pumping after returning to work.^{2,3} Breastfeeding can help reduce postpartum weight retention and also the risk of breast and ovarian cancer, and is recommended by the World Health Organization, United Nations Children's Fund and American Academy of Pediatrics to support optimal growth and development in infants.⁴⁻⁸ The WHO recommends exclusive breastfeeding of infants up to six months of age, which reduces rates of asthma, allergies and ear infections among children and decreases rates of maternal depression.^{9,10}

Solutions : Supportive breastfeeding programs - such as schedules that provide time for pumping or direct breastfeeding - lactation counseling and travel accommodations can help nursing mothers initiate and sustain breastfeeding.^{2,11} Lactation rooms that promote a comfortable, calm and private space, optimize thermal and acoustic comfort and maximize accessibility needs can support the needs of each individual.¹² Breastfeeding programs can decrease healthcare expenses, reduce employee absences associated with caring for a sick child and increase female employee retention.¹³

PART 1 OFFER WORKPLACE BREASTFEEDING SUPPORT (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

1: Breastfeeding support

The project or organization provides a policy to all eligible employees who are breastfeeding that meets the following requirements:

- a. Paid break times for nursing or pumping that last at least 20 minutes at least every 3 hours, with flexibility as necessary to meet individual needs.¹²
- b. One-time coverage or a subsidy of at least 50% for the purchase of a portable breast pump and/or availability of hospital-grade electric pump that accommodates multiple users.¹³
- c. Postpartum lactation counseling, including back-to-work lactation counseling, offered at no cost or subsidized by at least 50%.¹³

2: Support while traveling

The project or organization provides a policy to all eligible employees who are breastfeeding while traveling for business that meets the following requirements:

- a. For all trips: an insulated cooler is supplied at no cost or fully reimbursed.
- b. For all overnight trips: hotels (or other overnight accommodations) with refrigerator access.
- c. For trips lasting longer than 48 hours: full coverage or reimbursement for breastmilk shipping services (e.g., to have expressed milk shipped home).

PART 2 DESIGN LACTATION ROOM (MAX : 2 PT)

For All Spaces:

The project provides at least one dedicated lactation room for all employees that meets the following requirements:

- a. Is at least 4.6 m².¹²
- b. Includes, at a minimum, the following:
 1. Work surface and comfortable chair.¹²
 2. Two electrical outlets.¹²
 3. User-operated lock with occupancy indicator (e.g., signage).¹²
 4. Reservation system, designed to consider privacy preferences (e.g., utilizes a numbering system instead of individual names).^{12,13}
 5. Proximity to sink, faucet, paper towel dispenser and soap. These amenities are not required to be located in a lactation room but may not be located in a bathroom.¹²
 6. Refrigerator with dedicated, sufficient space for milk storage, based on assessment of user needs.¹²
 7. Dedicated microwave or other method to sanitize or sterilize pump equipment, through boiling, steaming, or other sterilizing solutions.¹⁴
 8. Dedicated storage space for pumping supplies.¹²
- c. Provides a calming and comfortable environment that addresses, at a minimum, the following:
 1. Sound minimization.¹²
 2. Ambient lighting.¹²
 3. Thermal comfort.¹²
- d. Present in a quantity that meets current and anticipated demand.¹³

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